

Meet the Lower Tees

I can locate the lower Tees, identify an estuary and explain one physical–human connection.

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

Arrival · retrieve the previous move

Standard

Arrival rule: retrieve before adding new content. Personal or family disclosure is never required.

Starter · question before verdict

Enquiry

How does the lower River Tees link land, water, people and the sea?

Retrieval question: Where does the lower Tees reach the sea?

- A. Teesmouth and the North Sea
- B. The Irish Sea
- C. A lake at Middlesbrough

I Do · model the disciplinary move

Model the decision and evidence, not just the answer.

STEP Trace with the key and arrows, not the shape on screen alone.

STEP Build the spatial sequence: river channel → estuary → mouth and sea.

STEP Place physical and human features together; position alone does not prove why they are there.

Lower Tees map · point, sort, link

CONSTRUCTED TEACHING SOURCE — not to scale; made for classroom practice.

I Do · model the disciplinary move

1 · Choose a dot on the map. 2 · Choose PHYSICAL (made by nature) or HUMAN (made by people). 3 · Build a link sentence.

A. PHYSICAL

B. HUMAN

Choose a dot to start. Green dots and orange dots are a hint, not the answer — say why.

Physical: — · Human: —

I Do · model the disciplinary move

Link sentence

- A. river → port
- B. tide → mudflats
- C. river → bridge
- D. river → town

Your sentence will appear here: '____ links to ____ because ____.'

- A. What does this map hide?

I Do · model the disciplinary move



Tappable schematic map of the lower Tees

We Do · evidence hinge

Commit before reveal: Which best describes an estuary?

- A. A wide tidal river area where fresh and sea water meet
- B. The top of a hill
- C. Any bridge

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

Model connection, limitation and honest uncertainty.

STEP Physical features include channel, tide, mudflat and bank.

STEP Human features include town, bridge, port and railway.

STEP The river offered routes and limits; people still made choices.

ADAPTED SOURCE CARD

HUM-B-W09-C01 · Lower Tees official context

Provenance source: HUM-B-W09-S01

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

The Environment Agency describes the Lower Tees and estuary catchment as stretching from Croft-on-Tees to the North Sea. Stockton, Middlesbrough and industrial areas sit within this lower catchment.

Can establish Shows the official modern lower-catchment extent and broad settlement pattern.

Cannot establish Does not prove why each town or industry developed in its position.

Accessible route Ordered reading route: Croft-on-Tees → Stockton → Middlesbrough → Teesmouth → North Sea.

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

CONSTRUCTED TEACHING SOURCE — created for classroom practice. It is not an archival original.

HUM-B-W09-C02 · Constructed Lower Tees schematic

Provenance source: HUM-B-W09-S02

A not-to-scale classroom route consulted against OS Open Rivers and the Environment Agency catchment description. It uses selected labels and omits minor watercourses, exact distances and administrative boundaries.

Can establish Supports route ordering and selected feature classification.

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

Cannot establish Cannot establish precise geometry, distance, historical river form or cause.

Accessible route The same five locations are supplied as a numbered text strip; colour is not needed to follow the route.

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

Interactive probe: response → evidence or representation → adult receives → next question or scaffold changes.

Lower Tees Layer Lab

CONSTRUCTED TEACHING SOURCE — created for classroom practice. It is not an archival original.

Disciplinary focus: Spatial sequence, feature classification and connection

Select one physical and one human feature, then complete: '____ links to ____ because ____.'

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

Upstream

Stockton

Middlesbrough

Teesmouth

North Sea

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

- A. route Upstream
- B. route Stockton
- C. route Middlesbrough
- D. route Teesmouth
- E. route North Sea

PHYSICAL

- channel
- estuary

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

- mudflat
- tide

HUMAN

- town
- bridge
- port
- railway

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

Evidence classification

- A. PHYSICAL channel
- B. PHYSICAL estuary
- C. PHYSICAL mudflat
- D. PHYSICAL tide
- E. HUMAN town
- F. HUMAN bridge
- G. HUMAN port

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

H. HUMAN railway

Accessible route: Ordered text route: upstream, Stockton, Middlesbrough, Teesmouth, North Sea. Feature labels name each category, so colour is never the only cue.

Independent · build defensible evidence

Independent humanities mission

Ordered and labelled Lower Tees representation, one physical–human connection and one limitation at the selected access route.

16 minutes. Supported, Standard and Stretch are movable routes, not pupil labels.

HUMANITIES STUDIO READY

Source / materials Teacher-prepared constructed lab cards plus the locally approved source cards named for this lesson.

Independent · build defensible evidence

Care / access Use the stated text, visual, pointing, sorting, speaking or exactly scribed route. No personal or family disclosure is required.

Evidence target Ordered and labelled Lower Tees representation, one physical–human connection and one limitation at the selected access route.

Supported

Order five route cards and explain the destination.

Evidence: Route strip plus one clue.

The Tees passes ____ then reaches ____.

Independent · build defensible evidence

Fade the first prompt no longer needed.

Standard

Label six features, including at least two physical and two human, and draw two because-arrows.

Evidence: Labelled map plus two links.

____ is near ____, so ____.

Stretch

Add an opportunity, a constraint and a map limit.

Independent · build defensible evidence

Evidence: Annotated map plus qualified explanation.

The river helped ____, but _____. This map cannot show _____.

Exit · receive, interpret, influence

Standard

Explain one physical–human link with ‘because’.

VOICE: The pupil gives the selected exit response and chooses ROUTE MAP or CARGO IMAGE for the next lesson; pointing, signing, speaking, annotating or exact scribing all count.

One BUILD Humanities close only; no signature, receipt, upload queue or second closure form.